Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

Rules Contributing to Suspicious AD Machine Account Creation Alert 6.2.0

The following rules are used to identify suspicious machine account creation activity in Active Directory. Any one or more of these will trigger the Suspicious AD Machine Account Creation Alert. Details for each rule can be viewed by clicking the **More Details** link in the description.

Title	Description

Active Directory MachineAccountQuota Compromise	MachineAccountQuota is an attribute in Active Directory that specifies how many machine accounts a user can create in the domain. Compromise of MachineAccountQuota occurs when an attacker abuses this privilege to create unauthorised machine accounts. Machine accounts are assigned credentials, just like user accounts. Attackers can extract the credentials (password hashes) for further use. These accounts can then be used for other malicious purposes, often bypassing standard account monitoring mechanisms.
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	`ad_machineAccountQuota_compromise`
	
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': [4741, 4720], 'TargetUserName|endswith': '$'}, 'condition': 'selection | count() by SubjectUserName > 3', 'timeframe': '15m'}`
	
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	
	Rule Source
	Developed internally by Stellar Cyber
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0003, T1136
	
	References
	• https://rootguard.gitbook.io/cyberops/detection-engineering/ad-attack-detections-and-mitigations/machineaccountquota-compromise
	
	Severity

Title	Description
50	

Suppression Logic Based On

- event_data.SubjectUserName
- stellar.rule_id

Additional Information

Maturity	Creation Date	Risk Level	False Positives
experimental	2025/06/13	medium	• False positives are possible if multiple machine accounts are created by legitimate users. We recommend excluding trusted service accounts or administrators. However, limiting the ability of non-privileged users to register devices is highly recommended.

© 2026 Stellar Cyber . All rights reserved.